Calendar

Spring 2027

Last modified: 2026-10-23

The topics and dates of future lectures may change.

Spring quarter runs from Tuesday, March 30 to Friday, June 11, 2027, with finals week from Monday, June 7 to Friday, June 11. Class meets on Mondays, Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Fridays, 9:00–9:50am, in CF 420. There is no class on Monday, May 31, for Memorial Day.

Mondays, Tuesdays and Wednesdays are lectures from these notes, apart from exam days and Memorial Day. Fridays are lab sessions, for working on the homework in class, except on the three Fridays that hold a midterm review.

Homework is due at 11:59 pm on its due date, always a Friday. Each self-grade is due one week after that homework's solutions are posted. The self-grade dates below assume the solutions go up at the deadline.

The three midterms are in class:

- Midterm 1, Monday, April 26: weeks 1 to 4, from the course overview through normalization and residual connections.
- Midterm 2, Monday, May 17: convolutional networks, sequence models, language modeling, attention, and Transformers' self-attention and positional encoding.
- Midterm 3, Tuesday, June 1: the lectures from Transformer pretraining through running deep learning experiments.

Each midterm covers the lectures since the one before it, and has an in-class review session on the Friday before the exam.

The final exam is optional. Its day and time are still to be set (TBD): WWU's finals schedule[1] sets each exam's slot from the class's start time and meeting days. The final's review session will be held during finals week, at a time TBD.

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Friday
Week 1 Mar 28 – Apr 3		Syllabus Course overview	Machine learning review (from lds[2]) Tensors (begun)	Lab session: Homework 1
Week 2 Apr 4 – Apr 10	Tensors and automatic differentiation	Feedforward networks: layers and activations	Feedforward networks: output units, losses, representational power	Lab session: Homework 1

[1] https://registrar.wwu.edu/calendars/finals
[2] https://morrison-lab.github.io/lds/

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Friday
Week 3 Apr 11 – Apr 17	Backpropagation	Optimization: minibatch stochastic gradient descent, momentum	Optimization: Adam, learning-rate schedules and warmup, initialization	Lab session: Homework 2 **Homework 1 due**
Week 4 Apr 18 – Apr 24	Regularization: weight decay, early stopping	Regularization: dropout, data augmentation	Normalization: batch and layer normalization; residual connections	**Midterm 1 review** **Homework 1 self-grade due**
Week 5 Apr 25 – May 1	**Midterm 1**	Convolutional networks: convolution arithmetic	Convolutional networks: pooling, classic architectures	Lab session: Homework 2
Week 6 May 2 – May 8	Convolutional networks: transfer learning	Sequence models: embeddings, recurrent networks	Sequence models: LSTMs and GRUs	Lab session: Homework 3 **Homework 2 due**
Week 7 May 9 – May 15	Language modeling	Attention: encoder-decoder attention	Transformers: self-attention, positional encoding	**Midterm 2 review** **Homework 2 self-grade due**
Week 8 May 16 – May 22	**Midterm 2**	Transformers: pretraining	Generative models: autoencoders and variational autoencoders	Lab session: Homework 3 and Homework 4 **Homework 3 due**
Week 9 May 23 – May 29	Generative models: generative adversarial networks	Generative models: diffusion	Running deep learning experiments: hyperparameter types, sweeps, compute budgets, reproducibility	**Midterm 3 review** **Homework 4 due** **Homework 3 self-grade due**
Week 10 May 30 – Jun 5	**No class: Memorial Day**	**Midterm 3**	Applications and current topics: large language models, fine-tuning, speech and vision; ethics	Lab session: Homework 5 **Homework 5 due** **Homework 4 self-grade due** **Course evaluations**
Finals week Jun 7 – Jun 11	**Optional final exam** Day and time TBD, per the WWU finals schedule[3] Review session: during finals week, time TBD **Homework 5 self-grade due** (Friday, Jun 11)			

[3] https://registrar.wwu.edu/calendars/finals